New York Knicks Coaching Strategy 2024-25 Offseason

Player Performance

<u>Is Jalen Brunson Carrying Too Much Of The Offense?</u>

- Was losing in the Eastern Conference Finals because of the lack of offensive help around Brunson?
- Does Brunson's high usage lead to less efficiency?

USAGE vs TS%		
Season Type	**Usage**	**TS%**
Regular Season	28.9	60.5
Post Season	31.5	58.2

Post Season Usage Rate - ↑ (Ranked 7th in the NBA Playoffs)

- Not a significant decrease in True Shooting Percentage

2024-25 Regular Season				
Split	**OffRtg**	**DefRtg**	**Net**	**Total Minutes**
On Court	119.9	117.8	2.1	2303
Off Court	117.1	110.1	7	1677
On - Off	2.8	7.7	-4.9	58%

2025 Playoffs				
Split	**OffRtg**	**DefRtg**	**Net**	**Total Minutes**
On Court	115.8	117.0	-1.2	681
Off Court	108.6	102.1	6.5	194
On-Off	7.2	14.9	-7.7	78%

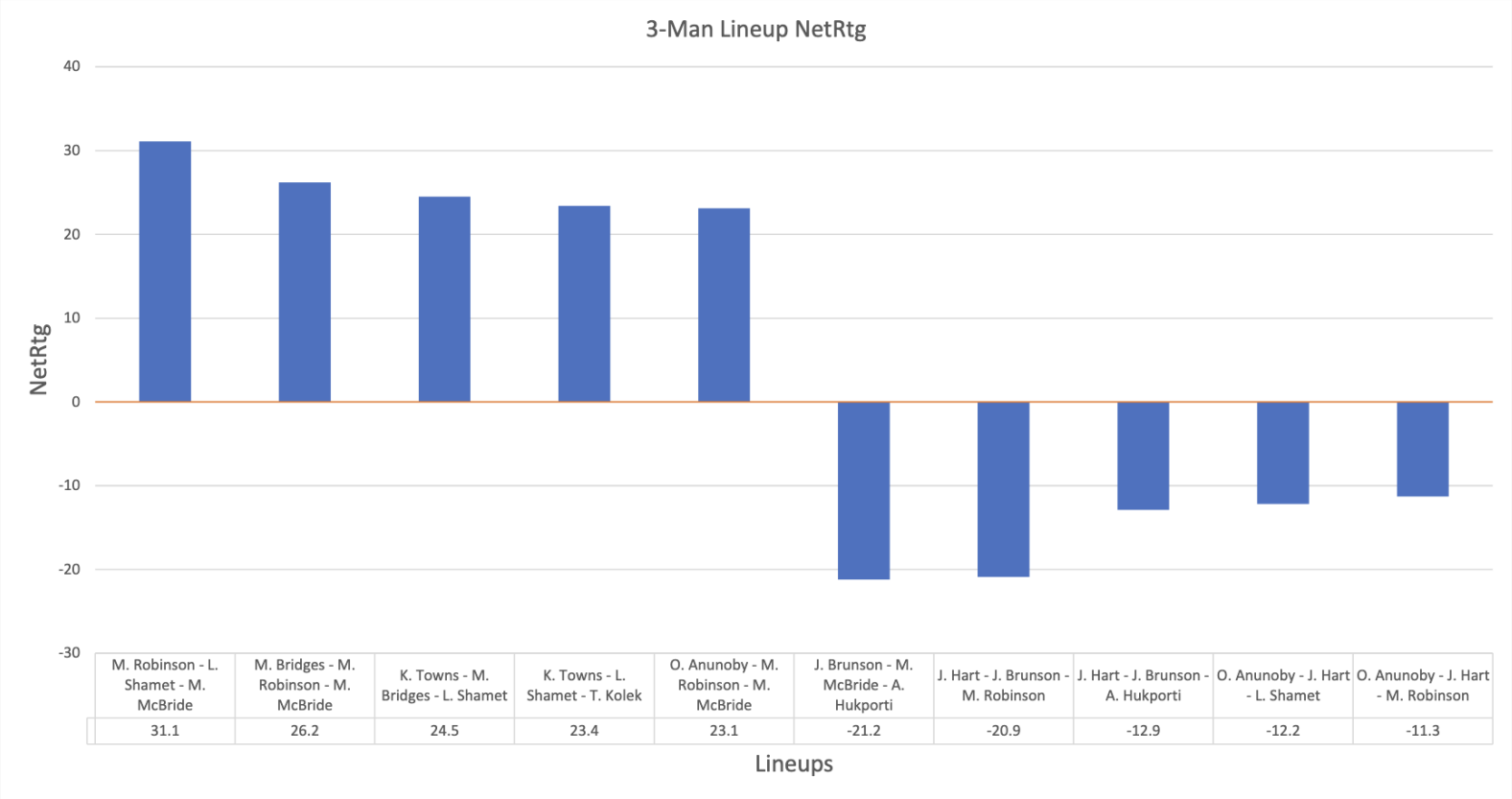
- Despite Brunson's sustained efficiency, his NetRtg went into the negatives in the playoffs
- The offense **STRUGGLED**, while the defense **THRIVED** with Brunson off the court
- A big critique last season was lack of bench usage. With the NetRtg being higher with Brunson off the court, it would have made sense to explore other rotations.
- 78% of the total minutes is normal for a starting point guard, however with the difference in NetRtg, that number should have been a bit lower to see how lineups without Brunson will perform given extended minutes.

Resolution: Optimize bench lineup to reduce the burden on Brunson

Lineup Analysis

<u>Which Lineup Actually Wins Minutes?</u>

- Are we using the best possible lineups?
- Which lineups are we under-utilizing?



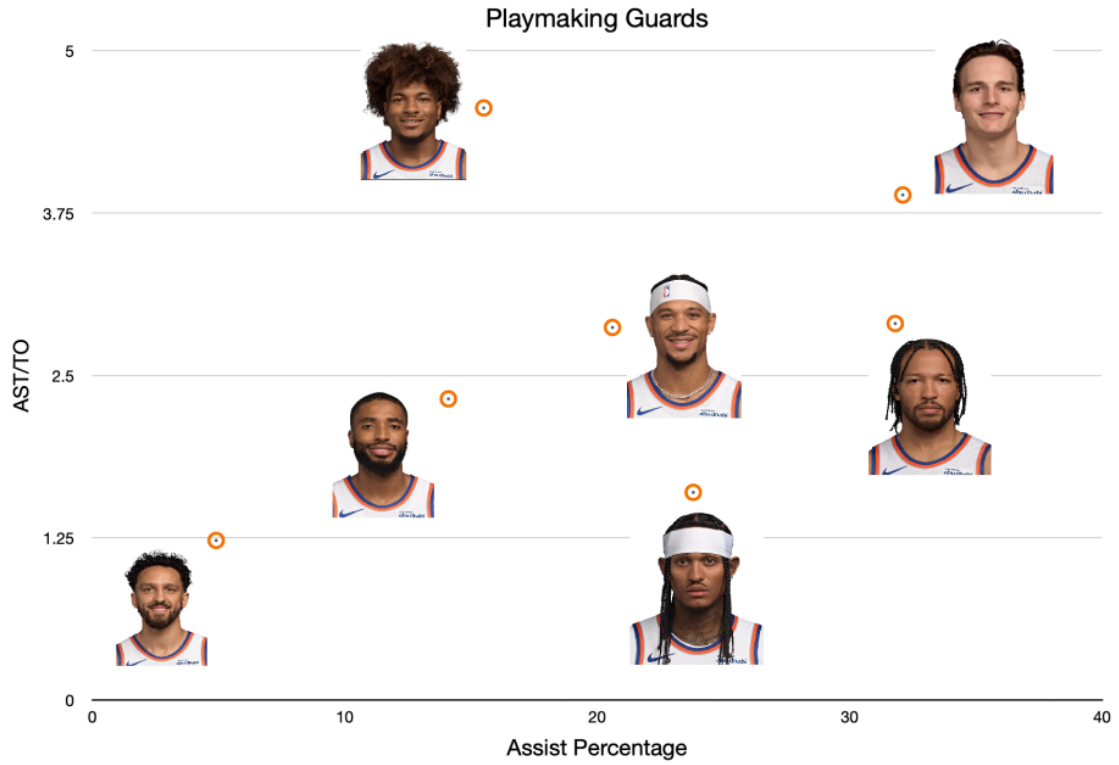
- Amongst players that played at least 50 minutes together and that are currently on the Knicks roster going into the 2025-26 season, Mitchell Robinson, Landry Shamet, and Miles McBride had the highest NetRtg. This lineup only played 55 minutes together during the regular season.
- This group typically comes off the bench. We need to increase their minutes and allow the starters to rest slightly more.
- Within this group, Jalen Brunson, Ariel Hukporti, and Miles McBride had the worst NetRtg. The minutes of this combination should be reduced.

Resolution: Allow the bench unit with high NetRtg to get extended minutes.
Monitor NetRtg as minutes increase

Team General Strategy

<u>How Should We Strategically Adjust To Avoid Last Year's Issues?</u>

- Offense significantly decreases in efficiency without Brunson on the court
- Too much reliance on isolation leads to high usage rate and lack of ball movement
- High minutes allocation to starters leading to fatigue late in the playoffs.



*Jordan Clarkson stats on the Utah Jazz

- Tyler Kolek averaged 7.2 minutes per game during the regular season and 2.2 minutes per game during the playoffs
- Kolek's numbers can be skewed due to playing against other bench players, but the high AST/TO and AST% in comparison to the other guards on the team displays his excellent ability to create shots for teammates while limiting turnovers. It would make sense to increase his minutes and monitor how increased playing time affects his stats.
- Miles McBride led the team with a 4.56 AST/TO ratio
- Increasing the roles of these players off the bench can potentially decrease the heavy reliance on Brunson, which might allow the team to maintain their offensive efficiency when Brunson is out of the game
- Playing more guards with high assist percentages can prevent the stagnant ball movement and lower the high dependence on isolation plays
- Involving more players can hopefully decrease the levels of fatigue from our star players

Resolution: Strategic change to play other playmakers like Miles McBride or Tyler Kolek with Jalen Brunson on the floor. Experiment two man combinations between the 3. Monitor Brunson's Usage & TS% efficiency. The DefRtg, OREB%, & AST% of the two small-guard lineups.

Game Specific Adjustments

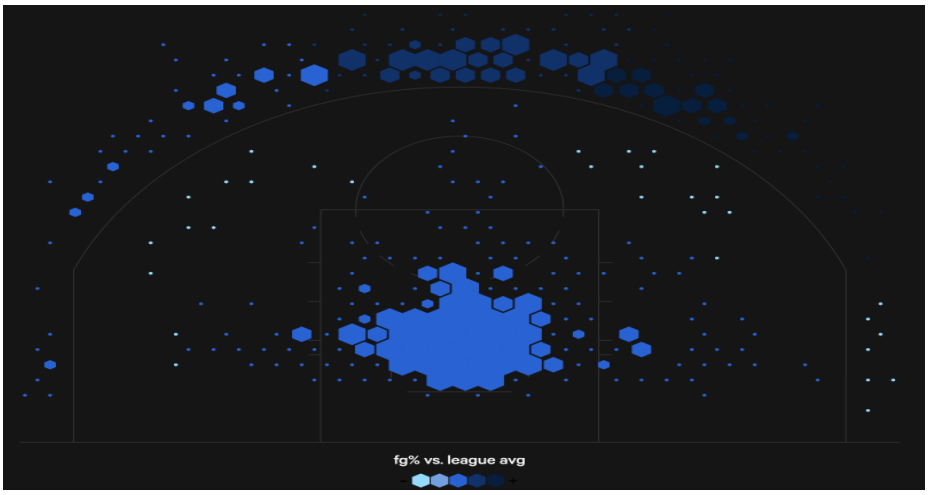
<u>How Do We Adjust Playing Against High Scoring Centers?</u>

- Karl Towns played a lot of minutes at center this past season due to Mitchell Robinson's lack of availability.
- The year prior, he mainly played at power forward for the Timberwolves alongside Rudy Gobert at center
- Karl Towns specialty isn't rim protection

Karl Towns vs Mitchell Robinson							
Player	OffRtg	DefRtg	NetRtg	OReb%	DReb%	Blk%	TS%
Towns	119.4	112.7	6.8	8.7	28.4	1.9	63.0
Robinson	113.8	108.2	5.7	17.4	17.6	5.8	67.6

- Mitchell Robinson's strengths over Karl Towns are higher DefRtg, OReb%, Blk%, and TS%.
- Robinson is a great shot blocker and anchor to the defense, which can allow us to explore lineups that have both Towns and Robinson on the floor together. This puts Towns back at a position where he thrived and also not have to carry the responsibility of rim protection/shutting down high scoring centers like Nikola Jokic and Joel Embiid.
- Karl Towns is a great shooter, so the two big man lineup shouldn't hurt floor spacing and overall team shooting numbers.

Karl Towns 2024-25 Shot Chart



Resolution: Experiment more with Mitchell Robinson and Karl Towns on the floor at the same time.

Monitor Towns 3PT%, Robinson-Towns 2-Man Lineup NetRtg

Data Collection

NBA.com 3-Man Lineup Data
NBA.com Advanced Stats
Basketball-Reference On-Off Stats
StatMuse Shot Chart Data